

A Deal to Stop the Bombs -- But Will It Last?

From: NPR World Mined: 2026-06-20 3 min read

Imagine a war so big it shakes the whole world making food and gas prices jump, and hurting millions of families. That's been happening in the **Middle East** for over three months. But this week, something surprising happened: U.S. President Trump and Iran's President Pezeshkian signed a paper called a **memorandum of understanding**. It's a promise to stop all fighting and talk about peace. Trump even posted, "Ships of the World, start your engines. Let the oil flow!" because a key waterway, the **Strait of Hormuz**, will reopen. But here's the catch: the deal only gives them 60 days to work things out. And right away, problems popped up. Israel, which wasn't part of the talks, kept bombing Lebanon, where it's fighting a group called **Hezbollah**. Israeli leaders say the deal doesn't protect them, so they won't stop. Iran says Israel must leave **southern Lebanon**, or the war isn't really over. **Vice President Vance** warned that Trump is Israel's best friend right now. So, is this a real step toward peace, or just a pause before more trouble? The whole world is watching.

Word Treasure

Middle East -- A large region where parts of Asia, Africa, and Europe meet, including countries like Iran, Israel, and Lebanon.

memorandum of understanding -- An official paper where leaders promise to work together, but it is not as strong as a full treaty.

Strait of Hormuz -- A narrow sea passage that connects the Persian Gulf to the ocean and carries a huge amount of the world's oil.

Hezbollah -- A powerful armed group based in Lebanon that often fights against Israel.

southern Lebanon -- The lower part of Lebanon, where fighting between Israel and Hezbollah has been taking place.

Vice President Vance -- The Vice President of the United States, who spoke about the U.S. friendship with Israel.

Background you need

The Middle East is a region that includes countries like Iran, Israel, and Lebanon, where there have been many conflicts over land and religion.

The Strait of Hormuz (a narrow water passage connecting the Persian Gulf to the ocean) is so important because about one-fifth of the world's oil travels through it.

Hezbollah (a Lebanese armed group supported by Iran) has fought against Israel many times, which is part of the larger tensions.

Break it down

WHO: U.S. President Trump and Iran's President Pezeshkian, with Vice President Vance and Israel.

WHAT: They signed a memorandum of understanding to stop all fighting for 60 days, but Israel kept bombing Lebanon.

WHERE: The Middle East, especially the Strait of Hormuz and southern Lebanon.

WHY: The war had been causing food and gas prices to rise worldwide, so the deal aims to bring peace and reopen the oil route.

Why it matters

This deal could lower gas prices and make it cheaper for your family to fill the car or buy food from faraway places.

Test what you remember

1. What did President Trump and President Pezeshkian sign?
 - ☐ (A) a peace treaty
 - ☐ (B) a memorandum of understanding
 - ☐ (C) a cease-fire
 - ☐ (D) a trade deal
2. What does the deal promise to stop?
 - ☐ (A) all fighting
 - ☐ (B) only oil fights
 - ☐ (C) only bombings
 - ☐ (D) only talks
3. Which waterway will reopen because of the deal?
 - ☐ (A) Suez Canal
 - ☐ (B) Panama Canal
 - ☐ (C) Strait of Hormuz
 - ☐ (D) Persian Gulf
4. How many days do they have to work things out?
 - ☐ (A) 30
 - ☐ (B) 60
 - ☐ (C) 90
 - ☐ (D) 120
5. Which country kept bombing Lebanon even after the deal was signed?
 - ☐ (A) Iran
 - ☐ (B) USA
 - ☐ (C) Israel
 - ☐ (D) France
6. Who warned that Trump is Israel's best friend right now?
 - ☐ (A) Vice President Vance
 - ☐ (B) President Pezeshkian
 - ☐ (C) a Hezbollah leader
 - ☐ (D) an Israeli leader

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: B 2: A 3: C 4: B 5: C 6: A

Questions to think about

1. **Peace supporters:** They hope the deal will stop the fighting and help families in the Middle East live safely again. It could also make oil and food cheaper worldwide.
2. **Israeli leaders:** They say the deal leaves them in danger because Hezbollah is still attacking, and they don't trust Iran to keep its promises.
3. **World observers:** Many countries are watching to see if the deal will actually work, because past agreements in the region have often failed.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):